

Defne Genç

defneg@stanford.edu • defne.io • linkedin.com/in/-defne

EDUCATION

- 2027 –
Ph.D. Computer Science (HCI), Stanford University
Admitted Fall 2027 (deferred). Interaction Design Lab, advised by James Landay.
- 2023 – 2025
M.S. Computer Science (HCI), Stanford University | GPA: 3.93
- 2020 – 2024
B.S. Symbolic Systems, Stanford University

EXPERIENCE

- Aug 2025 – Present
Product Manager, Coinbase (Institutional Derivatives Team)
 - Took Coinbase's first cross-exchange derivatives data surface from zero to one: coinbase.com/market-data/derivatives, normalizing volume, open interest, and funding rates across three exchanges (INTX, CDE, Deribit). Built the initial prototype solo against public APIs to win exec buy-in, then drove ~10 engineers from prototype to launch over three iterations.
 - Regularly ship production frontend code to the live market-data site and the international exchange UI.
 - Designed and own Coinbase's liquidity-support program for the Deribit acquisition (largest in crypto history) end to end: structured the incentive design through direct market-maker calls, drafted the legal addenda and participation agreements with counsel, wrote the client-facing API documentation, and ran all client communications from outreach through launch.
 - Self-taught into the team's primary owner of cross-exchange analytics, authoring hundreds of SQL queries and dashboards used across product, finance, and leadership.
- Sep 2024 – Present
Graduate Researcher, Bloom (CHI '26 Best Paper), Stanford HCI Group
 - Led UI/UX, LLM safety, and frontend for Bloom, an LLM coaching agent deployed to 54 users in a 4-week field study (CHI '26 Best Paper, top 1% of submissions).
 - Built the agent's guardrail and eval harness end to end: designed a harm taxonomy from domain-expert interviews, a 600-example red-team benchmark, and a production safety filter validated at >96% recall across harm categories.
 - Implemented most of the React Native frontend and a Streamlit + Firestore dashboard for live field telemetry. Designed the ambient display, avatar, and both treatment and control conditions.
 - Co-led the 54-participant field study: onboarded 22 participants in 1-hour sessions, coded all 54 offboarding interviews, and wrote the design, safety, and deployment sections of the paper.
- Jun 2024 – Sep 2024
Associate Product Manager Intern, Coinbase (Advanced Trade, Retail)
 - Scoped and shipped chart trading and custom price alerts on the retail surface.
 - Designed and shipped a promotional-tab A/B test estimated to lift international perpetual-trader onboarding by 20%.
- Jun 2023 – Jun 2024
Product Strategy Intern, BrewBird (Sequoia-backed coffee platform)
 - Sole design and product hire at a 30-person startup: rebuilt brewbird.com end to end and contributed to hardware product vision.
 - Analyzed machine error data in BigQuery to identify the key factors behind hardware failures in the field.
- Sep 2024 – Present
Course Assistant, Stanford Computer Science
 - CA across Stanford HCI courses: CS 147 (Intro to HCI; led an AI-supported language-learning studio), CS 347 (graduate HCI seminar), CS 278 (Social Computing).

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

- 2024 – 2025
Bloom: Designing for LLM-Augmented Behavior Change Interactions, 2nd author.
Jörke, Genç, Teutschbein, Sapkota, Chung, Schmiedmayer, Campero, King, Brunskill, Landay. arXiv:2510.05449.
arxiv.org/abs/2510.05449

PROJECTS (WWW.DEFNE.IO)

- 2026 – Present
Learning Et AI. — Solo, live at learningetal.com.
Daily research-digest agent that picks a central question, retrieves contrasting papers, then runs a multi-stage synthesis loop that self-critiques and revises before shipping. Next.js, TypeScript, FastAPI.
- 2025
Menuto — Solo full-stack AI dish-recommendation app.
Built a four-path menu-ingestion pipeline with LLM structure extraction into typed dish objects, plus a preference-learning recommendation loop.

SKILLS

TypeScript, React Native, Next.js, Python, FastAPI, SQLAlchemy, Agent Harnesses, Tool Use, LLM Evals & Safety, SQL, Snowflake, Product Management